



COMSATS Institute of Information Technology Wah

Pillars of Islam (Hajj/Pilgrimage)

Lecture No. 13

Hajj Definition:

Literally: in Arabic, Hajj means “The intent or “to go to”.

As a technical term: in Sharia (Islamic Law), Hajj is the name of those acts which are performed after entering into the state of Ihram with the Niyah (intention) of Hajj. They comprise Tawaf circumbulation of Ka’bah, Wuquf (stay) at Arafat etc.

Pilgrimage in Holy Quran:

الْحَجُّ أَشْهُرٌ مَّعْلُومَاتٌ ۖ فَمَنْ فَرَضَ فِيهِنَّ الْحَجَّ فَلَا رَفَثَ وَلَا فُسُوقَ وَلَا جِدَالَ فِي الْحَجِّ... [2:197]

For Hajj are the months well known. If any one undertakes that duty therein,

Let there be no obscenity, nor wickedness, nor wrangling in the Hajj...

فِيهِ آيَاتٌ بَيِّنَاتٌ مَّقَامُ إِبْرَاهِيمَ ۖ وَمَنْ دَخَلَهُ كَانَ آمِنًا ۗ وَلِلَّهِ عَلَى النَّاسِ حُجُّ الْبَيْتِ مَنِ اسْتَطَاعَ إِلَيْهِ سَبِيلًا... [87:3]

In it are Signs Manifest; (for example), the Station of Abraham; whoever enters it attains security; Pilgrimage thereto is a duty men owe to Allah,- those who can afford the journey...

وَأَذِّنْ فِي النَّاسِ بِالْحَجِّ يَأْتُوكَ رِجَالًا وَعَلَى كُلِّ ضَامِرٍ يَأْتِينَ مِنْ كُلِّ فَجٍّ عَمِيقٍ. (22: 27)

And proclaim unto mankind the pilgrimage. They will come unto thee on foot and on every lean camel; they will come from every deep ravine,-

Pilgrimage in Hadith:

He who performs Hajj in obedience to Allah’s command and abstain from all sensual or any other sinful acts, returns as innocent as a new born baby (Bukhari)

Whosoever possesses provisions and conveyance for the journey to the House of God, but in spite of this, does not perform Hajj, then his dying is like the dying of a Jew or a Christian (Tirmidhi).

Historical Background:

According to Hadith, elements of the Hajj trace back to the time of Abraham (Ibrahim), around 2500 BCE. Prior to Prophet Muhammad's era, each year tribes from all around the Arabian Peninsula would converge on Mecca, as part of the pilgrimage. The exact faith of the tribes was not important at that time, and Christian Arabs were as likely to make the pilgrimage as the pagans. Muslim historians refer to the time before Muhammad as jahiliyyah,

the "Days of Ignorance", during which the Kaaba contained hundreds of idols – totems of each of the tribes of the Arabian Peninsula. In 630 CE, Muhammad led his followers from Medina to Mecca; it was the first Hajj to be performed by Muslims alone, and the only Hajj ever performed by Muhammad. He cleansed the Kaaba, destroyed all the idols, and re-ordained the building as the house of God. It was from this point that the Hajj became one of the Five Pillars of Islam.

THE PILLARS OF UMRAH AND HAJJ

During Umrah and Hajj there are many religious acts carried out in order to fulfill the pilgrimage. Some of them are Pillars which are obligatory and some are recommended. The Pillars of Umrah are three:

Ihram (إحرام) the Hajj clothes

Tawaf (طواف) circumambulation of the Ka'bah

Sa'ee (سعي) going between Safaa and Marwah

Any other action, such as praying two rakah behind Maqam e Ibrahim, drinking Zam-Zam water and trimming the hair are recommended (sunan).

The Pillars of Hajj are four:

Ihram (إحرام) the Hajj clothes

Arafah (عرفة) staying in Arafah

Tawaf (طواف) circumambulation of the Ka'bah

Sa'ee (سعي) going between Safaa and Marwah

Types of Hajj:

There are three different ways to make Hajj

Hajj Al Ifrad (حج الأفراد) – Solely Hajj without to make Umrah

Hajj Al Qiraan (حج القران) - Umrah and Hajj with no break in ihram

Hajj At Tamattu (حج التمتع) – Umrah and Hajj with a break in ihram

HAJJ IS OBLIGATORY

The Hajj (Arabic: حج) is the Islamic pilgrimage to Mecca, Saudi Arabia. It is one of the largest pilgrimages in the world, and is the fifth pillar of Islam, a religious duty that must be carried out at least once in their lifetime by every able-bodied Muslim who can afford this. Abu Hurairah (ra) reported: Allah's Messenger (saw) addressed us and said: "O people, Allah has made Hajj obligatory for you; so perform hajj. Thereupon a person said: Messenger of Allah, (is it to be performed) every year? He (the Prophet) kept quiet, and he repeated (these words) thrice, whereupon Allah's Messenger (saw) said: If I were to say "Yes," it would become obligatory (for you to perform it every year) and you would not be able to do it..." [Muslim]

THE VIRTUES OF UMRAH AND HAJJ

There are many virtues for the ones who perform Hajj or Umrah correctly. Some of them have been listed below:

It is one of the best deeds Abu Hurairah reported: The Messenger of Allah was asked about the best of deeds. He (saw) said: Belief in Allah. He (the inquirer) said: What next? He (the Prophet) replied: Jihad (struggle to the utmost) in the cause of Allah. He (the inquirer) again said: What next? He (the Prophet) replied: Hajj Mabrouh (an accepted pilgrimage) [Bukhari].

The best supplication is on Arafah. The Messenger (saw) said. "The best supplication is the supplication on the day of Arafah (i.e. on Arafah)". [Tirmidhi]

It is expiation (kaffarah) for sin. Abu Hurairah (ra) reported Allah's Messenger (saw) as saying: "An Umrah is expiation for the sins committed between it and the next, and hajj which is accepted will receive no other reward than Paradise." [Muslim]

You will return like the day you were born (sinless). Narrated by Abu Hurairah: Allah's Apostle said: "Whoever performs hajj to this House (Ka'bah) and does not approach his wife for sexual relations nor commits sins (while performing hajj), he will come out as sinless as a newly-born child." [Bukhari]

Its reward is Paradise (Jannah). The Messenger (saw) said: "The accepted hajj has no other reward, except Paradise" [Bukhari]

THE CONDITIONS OF THE HAJJ

Hajj becomes obligatory upon the one who fulfills the following conditions:

Al Islam - To be Muslim

Al Aql – To be sane

Al Balough – To be mature (i.e. reach puberty)

Al Istataa'ah – To have capability. The capability is three:

Finance – to pay for travel and expenses, and have no debts

Health – to be able to perform all the rites of Hajj

Security – to be able to travel to and from without harm

Wajoub al Mahram – A woman must have a mahram with her when she goes for Hajj

If a Muslim fulfills all the above criteria, then he or she should not delay performing the Hajj.

Social effect of Hajj:

A 2008 study Entitled Estimating the Impact of the Hajj: Religion and Tolerance in Islam's Global Gathering, conducted in conjunction with Harvard University's found that the Hajj experience promotes peaceful coexistence, equality, and harmony. Specifically, the report states that the Hajj "increases belief in equality and harmony among ethnic groups and Islamic community and that "Hajjis show increased belief in peace, and in equality and harmony among adherents of different religions.

Procedure of Pilgrimage:

- Wear Ehram before Yalamlam with the intention of Umrah
- After reaching, perform Tawaf
- Then perform Sa'e (b/w Safa Marwah)
- Then offer two rakat's of Nafl, then hair cutting
- Then came out of Ehram

Philosophy of Pilgrimage:

- Cultural dimension
 - exchange of cultural values
 - people adopt good values
- Economic dimension
 - economic activities generated in all countries
 - trade and income level improves
 - Saudi economy gets huge boost